

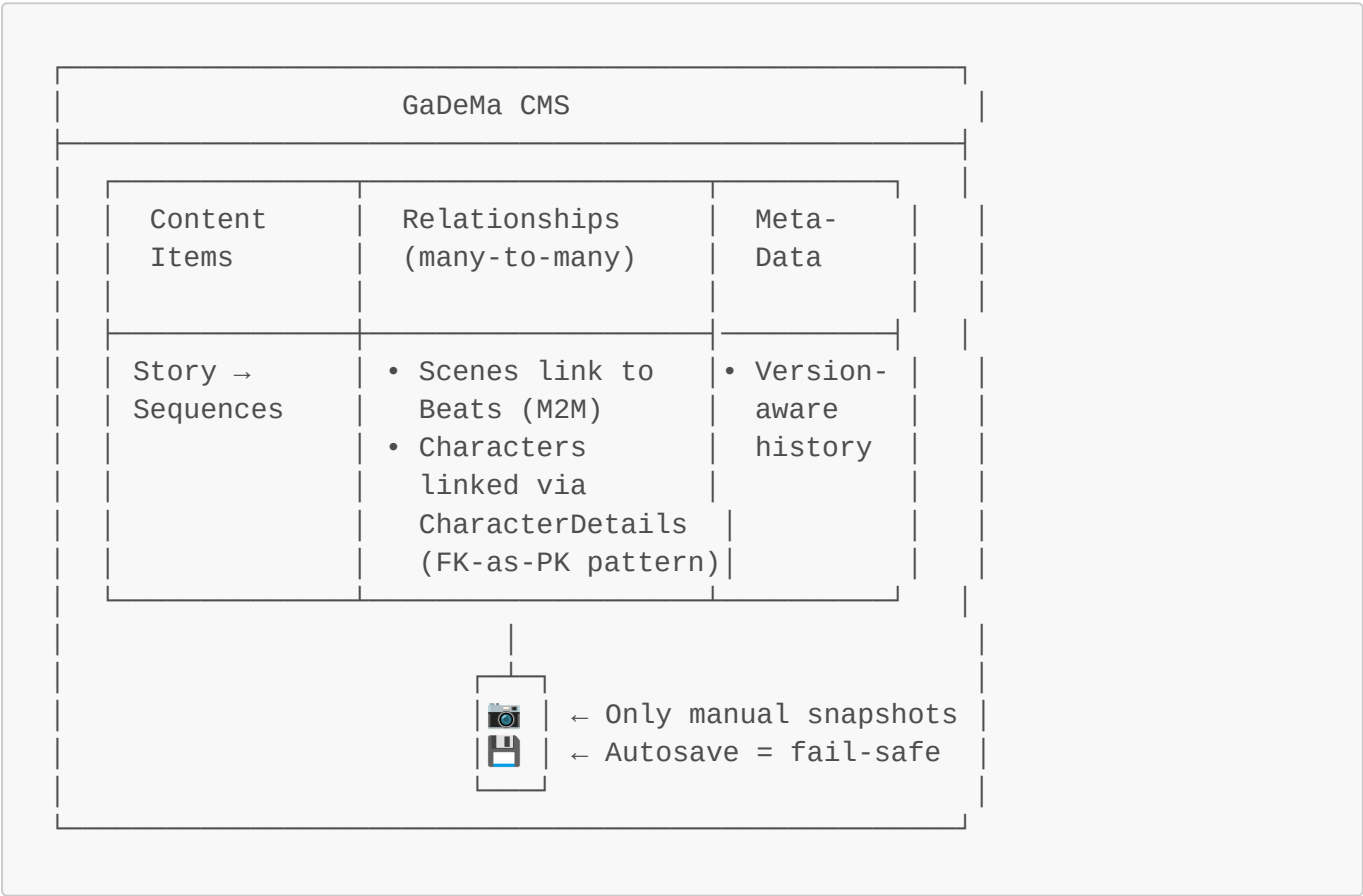
GaDeMa — ADHD-Friendly CMS Design Summary

Core Philosophy

Structure should serve the writer, not constrain them.

The system matches how ADHD brains actually work: non-linearly, associatively, and in bursts of focus followed by decision paralysis. Every design decision reduces friction between "I have an idea" and "that idea is safely stored."

Core Architecture

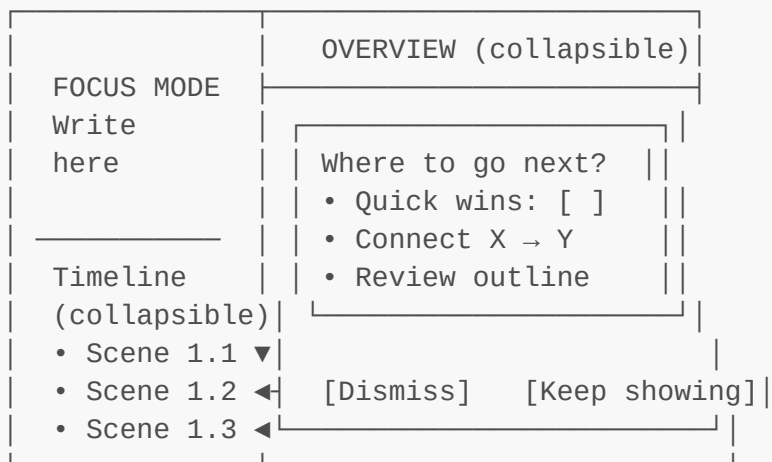


Key design decisions:

Entity	PK Strategy	Why
ProjectTaskComments	FK (TaskId) as PK column	Eliminates nullable primary keys; row = comment
ContentTags	Self-composite key (Id) + FKs inline	No separate junction table needed
CharacterBackground	FK (ContentItemId) as PK column	Direct link to character, no intermediate ID

🎨 UI/UX Design Decisions

1. Split Workspace with Ghost Preview



- **Ghost preview:** Small thumbnail of related elements visible but collapsible
- **Toggle with keyboard shortcut** — no mouse hunting needed
- Overview stays visible when collapsed, never hidden permanently

2. Two-Tier Save System (The Core Ritual)

Minor Save (Background)

[Save] → "✓ Saved in 0.4s • +127 words" → auto-dismisses after 3s

- **Overwrites** the last autosave silently
- **No version number shown.** Never says "v5."
- **No history entry created.** Invisible to version timeline.
- Purpose: *Safety only* — failsafe if you forget or crash.

Snapshot Save (Intentional)

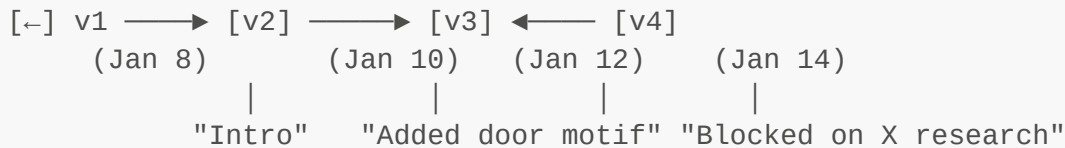
[📸 Save Snapshot] → "✓ Saved as Milestone #12" → comment field appears

- **Creates a real version** in the timeline
- **Requires one-line comment** — forces micro-reflection
- **Suggestions appear ONLY after this action**
- Purpose: *Commitment & reflection* — marking a boundary you chose

Autosave (The Silent Guardian)

- Runs every 30–60 seconds in background
- Creates **.autosaved** versions internally, never visible to the user
- If tab crashes or browser closes → reopens with last autosaved state immediately
- **Never contributes** to versioned snapshot history

3. Version History as a Visual Timeline (Not a List)



- **Horizontal scroll** — not a dropdown or modal
- Clicking any version jumps back to *that exact state*
- Comment appears as hover tooltip (not a full modal)
- Relative labels (**prev**, **next**) make navigation intuitive

4. "Where To Go From Here?" Panel

Appears **only after** a Snapshot Save. Dismissible at any time.

✨ Suggestions for what's next

⚡ Quick wins (no new research):

- [] Add a character emotion tag
- [] Tag this scene with "tension"

🔍 Related items to review:

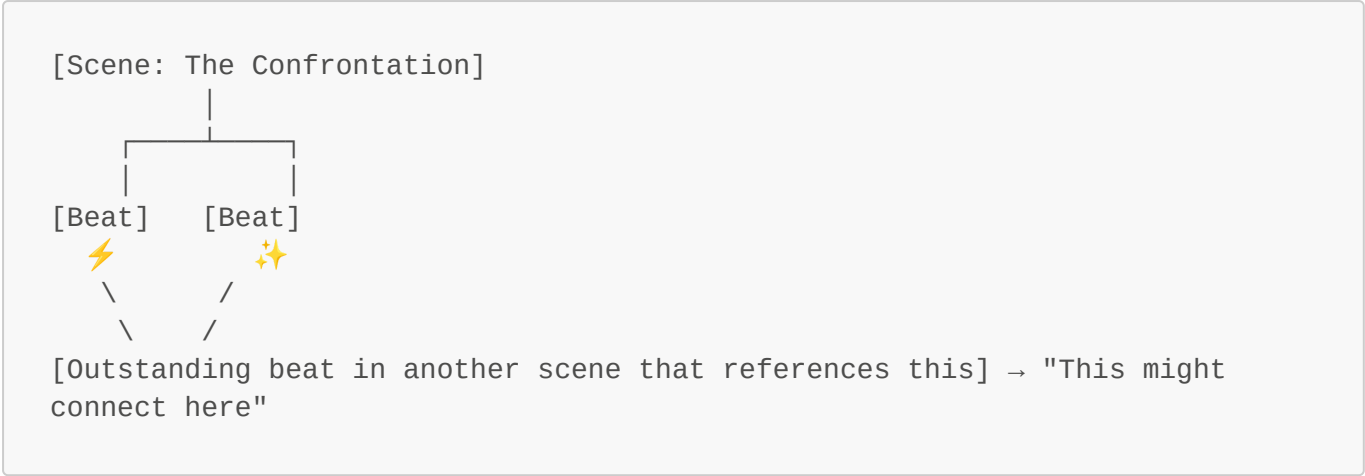
- The door motif appears in Scene 7
→ Should we resolve it?
- CharacterBackground for Protagonist
is outdated (last edited 3 weeks ago)

[Dismiss until next save] [Keep showing me]

Key rules:

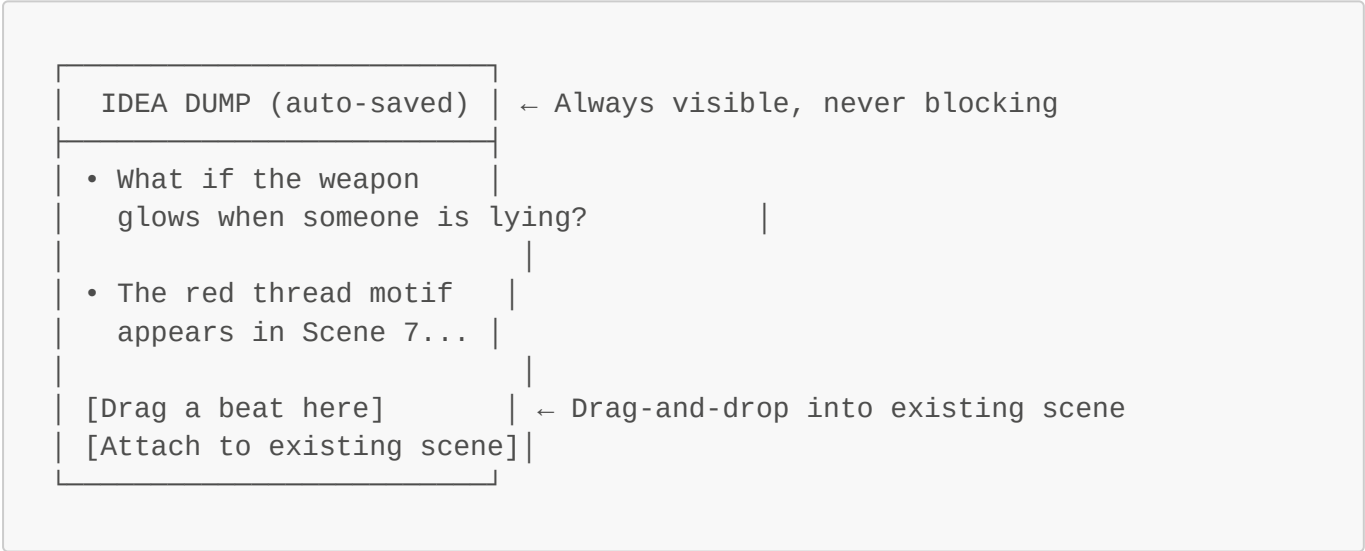
- Suggestions are **tied to the version** — if you undo to v2, suggestions disappear
- Can be dismissed without guilt ("I'll look at this on v4")
- No forms or multi-step setup required — single click to act

5. Connection Threads (Visual, Not Forced)



- Threads **pulse** when an unresolved link exists (a beat referenced elsewhere but not yet written)
- Dragging a thread between two elements creates the relationship — no forms
- If you don't know where something belongs? Leave it floating. The system suggests connections over time as you write more.

6. Idea Dump Zone (Non-Linear Capture)



- Ideas are saved instantly (no "write them down" friction)
- Can drag any idea into an existing scene later — no commitment required
- System gently suggests: "You wrote about X in Scene 3. Do you want to connect this?"

7. Time-Based Scaffolding Modes

Mode	What It Hides	When To Use
25-min sprint	Everything except current scene + timer	When writer's block hits — reduce noise
Freeform hour	All structure; no tags, no beats required	First draft, discovery writing
Retroactive planning	Writer writes first → AI asks: "What beats did you accidentally create?"	After the fact structuring

The Complete Flow (End-to-End)

PHASE 1: FLOW STATE

- Clean canvas – no suggestions visible
- Autosave happening silently in background
- Idea Dump open for capture (but non-intrusive)
- No decisions to make, no history to navigate

▼ [User stops typing / takes a break]

PHASE 2: COMMIT RITUAL

- Click [ Save Snapshot]
- One-line comment appears (required)
- Version enters the timeline
- Suggestions panel fades in *after* save

▼ [User chooses next action]

PHASE 3: DECISION POINT

- Click "Dismiss Suggestions" → back to flow
- Click a suggestion → it becomes the next task
- Or open a new draft without closing this one

▼ [User continues or dismisses]

PHASE 4: BACK TO FLOW

- Suggestions can be dismissed
- Overview mode collapses suggestions
- User returns to clean writing space

This loop is the core of the ADHD-friendly workflow:
Flow → Commit → Decide → Flow → ...

What We Explicitly Avoid (Anti-Patterns)

Pattern	Why It Fails for ADHD	Our Alternative
Auto-save prompts ("You haven't saved!")	Creates anxiety, feels like nagging	Silent autosave; only snapshot creates visible history
Mandatory outlines before writing	Blocks momentum entirely	Outlines are optional attachments on any layer

Pattern	Why It Fails for ADHD	Our Alternative
Multi-step versioning dialogs	Friction kills the completion feeling	One-click snapshot → one-line comment → done
Linear tree navigation (Scene 1.1 → 1.2 → 1.3)	Doesn't match how ADHD brains associate ideas	Graph-based linking: drag threads between any elements
Pop-ups and modals for suggestions	Breaks flow, feels intrusive	Suggestions appear only after intentional save; dismissible at any time



Summary of Core Principles

1. **Progressive disclosure** — Hide complexity until the user is ready to engage with it (save → then show suggestions)
2. **Ritual over friction** — Turn "I should have saved" into a satisfying completion ritual that feels like progress, not work
3. **Capture > structure** — Ideas are captured first; organization comes later as an optional layer on top
4. **Visual timeline over lists** — Temporal relationships are shown spatially (horizontal scroll), not hierarchically (dropdowns)
5. **Suggestions are suggestions** — Never required, never sticky, always dismissible with zero guilt

This is the complete design system for GaDeMa as an ADHD-friendly CMS. It's built on the insight that the tool shouldn't *fix* the writer's thinking process — it should match it and provide scaffolding only when explicitly invited to do so.